

# EV POWERTRAIN

# Cooling & Lubrication System

Systems Engineering Reference

Electric Motor · Inverter · Oil Pump · Thermal Management · Drive Cycles · Derating Calibration ·  
Oil Lifetime

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Jaguar Land Rover — Electric Drive Unit Programme  
Powertrain Thermal Systems Engineering

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CHAPTER 1

System Overview

EV Cooling & Lubrication Architecture

1.1 The Two Primary Thermal Loops

An EV powertrain thermal management system operates two fundamentally different cooling circuits that must work in concert to protect the motor, inverter, and gearbox. Understanding how these loops interact is the starting point for all thermal engineering work.

Oil Circuit — Lubrication & Direct Cooling

The oil circuit uses Automatic Transmission Fluid (ATF) or a dedicated e-motor oil. This fluid makes direct physical contact with the motor's rotating components and is therefore capable of removing heat from surfaces that coolant can never reach. Key functions include end-winding spray cooling, rotor shaft feed, bearing lubrication, gear mesh lubrication, and differential lubrication.

- Fluid: ATF or dedicated EV e-motor oil (e.g., 0W-20 synthetic)
- Direct contact with copper windings, rotor surfaces, bearings, and gear teeth
- Oil-to-water heat exchanger transfers heat to the coolant circuit
- Typical flow range: 2–10 L/min depending on demand
- Sump temperature limit: 125–130°C for sealed-for-life design

Coolant Circuit — Indirect Cooling

The coolant circuit uses a water-glycol mixture (50/50 by volume) and is completely isolated from rotating and live electrical components. It removes heat from the stator housing jacket and the inverter cold plate, then rejects that heat to the vehicle radiator or chiller via the Vehicle Thermal Management System (VTMS).

- Fluid: Water-Glycol 50/50, density ~1060 kg/m³, Cp ~3600 J/kg·K
- Cools: Stator housing jacket, inverter cold plate, HV battery (separate loop in some architectures)
- Never contacts rotating or electrically live components
- Typical flow range: 10–25 L/min
- Maximum coolant inlet temperature: 70°C at worst case ambient

| Parameter          | Oil Circuit                | Coolant Circuit            |
|--------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|
| Fluid              | ATF / EV Oil (0W-20)       | Water-Glycol 50/50         |
| Density            | ~870 kg/m³                 | ~1060 kg/m³                |
| Specific Heat (Cp) | ~2000 J/kg·K               | ~3600 J/kg·K               |
| Typical Flow       | 2–10 L/min                 | 10–25 L/min                |
| Temp Range         | –40°C to 130°C             | –40°C to 115°C             |
| Pump Type          | Electric Oil Pump (EOP)    | PWM Electric Water Pump    |
| Heat Sink          | Oil-to-Water HEX → Coolant | Vehicle Radiator / Chiller |
| Key Interfaces     | Windings, bearings, gears  | Stator housing, cold plate |

CHAPTER 2

Oil Pump Sizing

Flow Rate & Pump Speed Determination

2.1 Core Relationship — Heat Rejection Drives Flow

A fundamental principle in EV thermal engineering is that oil flow demand is driven primarily by the heat rejection requirement, not by motor speed alone. This is in contrast to an ICE transmission where oil flow is often mechanically linked to engine speed. The electric oil pump (EOP) in an EV is fully decoupled, allowing independent thermal and lubrication control across all operating conditions.

$$Q_{\text{required}} = P_{\text{loss}} / (\rho \times C_p \times \Delta T_{\text{allowable}})$$

$Q$  = volumetric flow rate (m3/s or L/min)  
 $P_{\text{loss}}$  = heat generated in component (W)  
 $\rho$  = oil density (~870 kg/m3 for ATF)  
 $C_p$  = specific heat capacity (~2000 J/kg.K)  
 $\Delta T$  = allowable temperature rise across component (K)

2.2 Speed-vs-Flow Decision Map

| Operating Condition                | Speed Range    | Primary Heat Source                               | Oil Flow Need                              |
|------------------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Low speed / high torque (launch)   | 0–2000 RPM     | High I <sup>2</sup> R copper losses, bearing load | HIGH — maximum flow required               |
| Mid-range cruise                   | 3000–6000 RPM  | Mixed copper + iron losses                        | Medium flow                                |
| High speed, light load             | 8000–15000 RPM | Windage losses, churning dominant                 | Moderate (churning losses rise sharply)    |
| Peak / launch event                | Any speed      | Maximum total losses everywhere                   | MAXIMUM — pump at ceiling speed            |
| Stationary with torque (hill hold) | 0 RPM          | Sustained I <sup>2</sup> R, zero windage          | HIGH — no centrifugal oil distribution aid |

2.3 Pump Speed Scheduling

Most modern EV EDUs use an electric oil pump (EOP) that is fully software-controlled. The pump speed is determined by a multidimensional lookup table arbitrated by the thermal control strategy. The final pump speed command is the maximum of all contributing demand sources.

Pump Speed Arbitration Logic (Pseudocode)

EOP Target RPM = MAX( lookup\_2D(motor\_torque, motor\_speed), // performance demand  
lookup\_1D(max(T\_winding, T\_oil\_sump)), // thermal demand  
VSC\_minimum\_flow\_request // system floor )  
// Convert RPM to actual flow via pump curve: actual\_flow = pump\_curve(EOP\_target\_RPM, system\_back\_pressure)

The pump H-Q curve (pressure head vs volumetric flow at each RPM) is the critical calibration input. Without an accurate H-Q curve, all flow estimates in the ECU are wrong. This curve must be measured on a flow bench at multiple oil temperatures because viscosity strongly affects pump delivery.

CHAPTER 3

# Coolant Flow Rate

*Sizing, Targets & Control Strategy*

## 3.1 Coolant Sizing Logic

The coolant circuit must remove the combined heat load from the inverter cold plate and the stator housing jacket. The fundamental sizing equation is the same as for oil but uses water-glycol fluid properties. The temperature rise across the circuit (delta-T) is a key design choice — smaller delta-T means better cooling but requires higher flow rate and therefore more pump power.

$$Q_{coolant} = (P_{inverter\_loss} + P_{stator\_jacket\_loss}) / (\rho_{wg} \times C_{p\_wg} \times \Delta T)$$

Water-Glycol 50/50 properties:  $\rho = 1060 \text{ kg/m}^3$   $C_p = 3600 \text{ J/kg.K}$  Typical  $\Delta T$  across cold plate: 5 to 15 degC

| Component                 | Typical Flow (L/min) | Max Inlet Temp | Typical delta-T |
|---------------------------|----------------------|----------------|-----------------|
| Inverter cold plate       | 8–15                 | 65°C           | 5–10°C          |
| Stator housing jacket     | 10–20                | 70°C           | 8–15°C          |
| Combined EDU coolant loop | 15–25                | 70°C           | 10–15°C         |

## 3.2 Coolant Flow Control Strategy

- Low load: Minimum flow to reduce pump parasitic power loss and maximise range
- High load or hot ambient: Maximum pump speed — full flow to maintain component temperatures
- Thermal soak (post-drive): Run-on pumping continues after ignition off to pull residual heat from inverter and motor housing before shutdown
- VSC coordinates with HVAC system — if AC compressor is running, radiator inlet temperature is managed jointly
- PWM water pump: Typically controlled 0–100% duty cycle via thermal controller CAN message

## CHAPTER 4

## Electric Motor Thermal Model

*Lumped Parameter Thermal Network (LPTN)*

## 4.1 LPTN Theory

The motor thermal model is the most important analytical tool in EV cooling engineering. It models the motor as a network of thermal resistances (R) and thermal capacitances (C) — an exact analogy to an electrical RC circuit where heat flow replaces current and temperature replaces voltage. This analogy is powerful because circuit analysis techniques can be applied directly to thermal problems.

**Heat Flow (W) = Temperature Difference (K) / Thermal Resistance (K/W) [analogous to  $I = V/R$ ] Thermal Capacitance (J/K) = Mass (kg) x Specific Heat  $C_p$  (J/kg.K) [stores heat energy, causes thermal lag] Time Constant:  $\tau = R \times C$  (seconds)**

## Key Thermal Nodes in the Motor Model

| Node                | Physical Location                | Primary Heat Source             | Typical Time Constant |
|---------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------|
| T_copper (hot spot) | Deepest winding in slot          | $I^2R$ copper loss              | 30–60 s               |
| T_end_winding       | Winding overhang outside slot    | $I^2R$ copper loss              | 30–90 s               |
| T_stator_tooth      | Iron core between slots          | Iron eddy + hysteresis loss     | 60–180 s              |
| T_stator_yoke       | Outer ring of stator iron        | Iron loss (lower)               | 120–300 s             |
| T_housing           | Stator outer cylindrical surface | Conducted from stator           | 300–600 s             |
| T_magnet            | Embedded in rotor                | Magnet eddy currents, conducted | 100–300 s             |
| T_rotor_iron        | Rotor lamination stack           | Rotor iron losses               | 100–400 s             |
| T_shaft             | Motor shaft                      | Conducted from rotor            | 200–500 s             |
| T_bearing           | Bearing inner/outer race         | Conducted + friction loss       | 150–400 s             |

## 4.2 Stator Thermal Model

The stator is the primary heat source in an IPM motor at most operating conditions. The slot liner — a thin sheet of electrical insulation between the copper and the stator iron — is the dominant thermal resistance in the stator heat path. Its thermal conductivity is typically only 0.2 W/m·K (compared to copper at 400 W/m·K and silicon steel at 25 W/m·K). This is why end-winding oil spray is so thermally effective — it bypasses this slot liner resistance entirely.

**Stator Loss Equations**

Stator heat generation: Copper Loss =  $I_{rms}^2 \times R_{dc} \times K_{ac} \times (1 + \alpha \times \Delta T)$   $K_{ac}$  = AC resistance factor (skin effect, proximity effect)  $\alpha_{copper} = 0.00393$  per degC Iron Loss =  $k_h \times f \times B_{peak}^2 + k_e \times f^2 \times B_{peak}^2$   $k_h$  = hysteresis coefficient (material-dependent)  $k_e$  = eddy current coefficient  $f$  = electrical frequency = (RPM/60) x pole\_pairs  $B$  = peak flux density (Tesla)



### 4.3 Rotor Thermal Model

The rotor presents a fundamentally harder thermal problem than the stator. It rotates at up to 20,000 RPM, making direct coolant access impossible. Heat must conduct outward through solid material — from magnet to rotor iron to shaft to bearing to housing — a thermal path with significantly higher resistance than the stator path. The rotor thermal time constant is therefore 3–5 times longer than the stator, meaning rotor temperature continues rising even after the electrical load is removed. This thermal soak behaviour is critical for post-drive thermal management strategy.

| Rotor Heat Source                 | Speed Dependence                            | Torque Dependence                            | Peak Risk Condition             |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Magnet eddy currents              | Strong ( $\propto f^2$ )                    | Moderate (via current halving in high speed) | High speed, field weakening     |
| Rotor iron eddy loss              | Strong ( $\propto f^2$ )                    | Low                                          | High speed, light torque cruise |
| Rotor iron hysteresis             | Linear ( $\propto f$ )                      | Low                                          | High speed operation            |
| Conducted from stator via air gap | Moderate (convection $\uparrow$ with speed) | Strong (stator hotter at high torque)        | Low speed, high torque          |

## CHAPTER 5

## Continuous vs Peak Performance

## Thermal Constraints &amp; Ratings

## 5.1 The Power-Duration Curve

Every electric motor has two distinct power ratings: a peak rating valid for a limited duration (typically 10–30 seconds), and a continuous rating that can be sustained indefinitely. The boundary between these regions is entirely defined by the thermal management system. A better cooling system directly translates into a higher continuous rating and a longer peak duration.

**Continuous Power:** Operating point where  $dT_{\text{winding}}/dt = 0$  (thermal equilibrium reached with  $T_{\text{winding}} < T_{\text{limit}}$ ) Cooling system MUST reject all losses at steady state. **Peak Duration:**  $t_{\text{peak}} = (m \times C_p \times \Delta T_{\text{allowed}}) / P_{\text{loss\_excess}}$   $m$  = thermal mass of motor (kg)  $C_p$  = weighted specific heat (J/kg.K)  $\Delta T = T_{\text{limit}} - T_{\text{initial}}$   $P_{\text{loss}}$  = heat generation at peak operating point (W)

## 5.2 Temperature Limits by Component

| Component                  | Continuous Limit | Peak Limit | Failure Mode if Exceeded             |
|----------------------------|------------------|------------|--------------------------------------|
| Stator winding (Class H)   | 180°C            | 200–210°C  | Insulation breakdown → short circuit |
| Stator winding (Class C)   | 200°C+           | 220°C+     | Insulation carbonisation             |
| Rotor magnet (NdFeB N45SH) | 120°C            | 140–150°C  | Irreversible demagnetisation         |
| Bearing (all types)        | 120°C            | 150°C      | Fatigue spalling, seizure            |
| Oil sump                   | 125°C            | 135°C      | Oil oxidation, varnish, seal failure |
| IGBT junction (Si)         | 150°C            | 165°C      | Thermal runaway, device failure      |
| SiC MOSFET junction        | 175°C            | 185°C      | Bond wire failure, short             |
| Gear steel surface         | 120°C            | 140°C      | Scuffing, micropitting               |

## 5.3 Thermal Derating Algorithm Overview

When component temperatures approach their limits, the ECU activates a controlled torque reduction called thermal derating. The derating strategy must balance hardware protection against driver experience — overly aggressive derating creates customer complaints while insufficient derating risks permanent hardware damage.

## Derating Arbitration Logic

```
// Multi-input torque limit arbitration in motor controller: Torque_limit = MIN( f(T_winding),
// winding insulation protection f(T_magnet), // demagnetisation protection f(T_junction), //
// inverter IGBT/SiC protection f(I_phase_limit), // current limit (temp-dependent) f(V_dc, RPM),
// voltage/flux limit f(T_bearing), // bearing protection f(T_oil_sump) // oil degradation
// protection )
```

CHAPTER 6

# Drive Cycles & Testing

From Component to Vehicle Level Validation

## 6.1 Standard Drive Cycles

| Cycle        | Region       | Max Speed | Character                             | Thermal Significance                       |
|--------------|--------------|-----------|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| WLTP Class 3 | Global/EU    | 131 km/h  | Mixed urban + extra-urban + highway   | Global standard — homologation requirement |
| US06         | USA          | 129 km/h  | Aggressive, rapid acceleration        | Worst-case peak thermal stress             |
| NEDC         | Legacy EU    | 120 km/h  | Gentle, low average speed             | Too mild — being phased out                |
| RTS-95       | EU           | 120 km/h  | Highway-focused, sustained high speed | Persistent thermal load on rotor           |
| FTP-75       | USA          | 91 km/h   | Urban, stop-start                     | Low-moderate thermal load                  |
| Custom OEM   | OEM-specific | Variable  | Grade climbs, towing, trailer         | Worst-case use-case validation             |

## 6.2 Motor Component Level Tests

### Thermal Mapping Test

The motor thermal mapping test is the foundational dataset for the entire thermal engineering programme. It measures steady-state temperatures at every point in the motor's operating envelope and is used to calibrate the LPTN thermal model.

Thermal Mapping Procedure

Test Setup: Motor on dyno with controlled external coolant and oil supplies Thermocouples: end winding (x4), stator tooth (x2), yoke (x2), housing (x4), oil in/out, coolant in/out, bearings (x2) Flow meters on both oil and coolant circuits Test Matrix: Torque: 50, 100, 150, 200, 250, 300 Nm Speed: 500, 1000, 2000, 4000, 8000, 12000 RPM T\_coolant\_in: 40, 65 degC T\_oil\_in: 60, 90 degC Oil flow: 3, 6, 9 L/min Coolant flow: 10, 15, 20 L/min Procedure per point: 1. Start from cold soak (all temps = 25 degC) 2. Apply constant torque and speed 3. Wait for equilibrium: dT/dt < 0.5 degC/min on all sensors 4. Record all temperatures, flows, pressures 5. Cool down fully before next point Total points: 200-400 steady-state operating points Typical duration: 3-6 weeks of dyno time

### Continuous Rating Validation

This test proves the motor can sustain its rated continuous torque indefinitely without any temperature exceeding its limit. This is a direct verification of the continuous power requirement cascaded from the vehicle level.

Continuous Rating Test

Procedure: 1. Pre-condition motor to warm but stable state 2. Apply continuous torque (e.g., 160 Nm) at worst thermal speed (typically base speed – highest current for given torque) 3. Run until ALL temperatures reach equilibrium (30-90 minutes) Pass Criteria (worst case: T\_coolant\_in=70 degC, T\_oil\_in=90 degC): T\_winding\_steady\_state < 175 degC (5 degC margin to 180 degC limit) T\_magnet\_steady\_state < 115 degC (5 degC margin to 120 degC limit) T\_bearing\_steady\_state < 115 degC T\_oil\_out < 125 degC

## Peak Rating & Derating Validation

### Peak Duration Test

Phase 1 – Cold Peak: Motor at 25 degC cold soak Apply peak torque instantly Record time until T\_winding hits derate threshold Compare to thermal model prediction Phase 2 – Hot Peak (worst case for customer): Pre-condition at continuous rating until thermal equilibrium Apply peak torque from hot starting condition Record time to derate – will be significantly shorter than cold peak Phase 3 – Derate Behaviour Validation: Deliberately run into derate zone Confirm torque reduction follows calibrated slope Confirm smooth recovery – no hunting or oscillation Measure recovery time after load removal

## 6.3 EDU Integration Level Tests

At EDU level, motor, inverter, and gearbox are tested as an integrated assembly. New thermal phenomena emerge at this level that do not exist in motor-only tests: inverter switching losses heat the coolant before it enters the motor; gearbox churning losses heat the oil before it reaches the end windings; real oil distribution across multiple jets can be measured.

### Drive Cycle Simulation on EDU Dyno

#### EDU Drive Cycle Test

Test Objective: Validate complete thermal system against transient drive cycle Setup: EDU on dyno, speed/torque time trace replayed from drive cycle data All real-world components: real inverter, real gearbox, real pump Instrumented with full thermocouple harness Key difference from steady state: TRANSIENT behaviour validated – thermal capacitance C values tested Model must predict temperature TRAJECTORY, not just final value Pass Criteria: T\_winding predicted vs measured: within +/-8 degC throughout cycle Temperature PEAKS correctly predicted (drives derating decisions) No temperature limit exceeded at any point during cycle

### Worst-Case Thermal Stress Tests

| Test Name             | Procedure                                                  | What It Validates                                  |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Repeated Launch       | Full peak torque 0→100 km/h, coast back, repeat            | Peak thermal capacity, inverter activation         |
| Sustained Grade Climb | Simulate 10% grade at 120 km/h for 30 minutes continuously | Continuous derating at worst sustained condition   |
| Hot Ambient Grade     | As above but with coolant inlet forced to 70°C             | True worst-case combined condition                 |
| Hot Soak Restart      | Motor at 80°C thermal soak, immediately apply peak torque  | Derating on hot restart — customer worst case      |
| Cold Start High Load  | –20°C cold soak, full torque demand immediately            | Oil viscosity, pump priming, cold start protection |

## 6.4 Vehicle Level Validation

### Climatic Chamber Testing

| Climate Condition     | Chamber Setting   | Key Tests                                 | Pass Criteria                                   |
|-----------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Hot Climate           | +45°C, solar load | WLTP + grade climb + repeated launch      | No derating in WLTP; grade without limit breach |
| Cold Climate          | –20°C to –40°C    | Cold start, warm-up strategy, first drive | Oil primes within 5s; full torque within 2 min  |
| Altitude Simulation   | Reduced pressure  | Sustained load at altitude                | Thermal margin still adequate                   |
| Humidity/Condensation | High RH cycling   | Thermal cycling cold-hot                  | No water ingress to oil; seal integrity         |

## Proving Ground Testing

- Arizona (Death Valley, July): 45–50°C ambient — real-world radiator inlet temperature at maximum; sustained motorway cruise, towing in hills, repeated hard acceleration from traffic lights
- Sweden / Northern Canada (January): –30 to –40°C — cold start oil viscosity validation, pump priming, warm-up time to full performance, heater demand interaction
- Alps / Pikes Peak: Sustained grade climb — worst-case continuous thermal scenario; repeated ascent (back-to-back) for thermal soak validation
- Dubai / Abu Dhabi: 45°C + high humidity — dual stress on cooling and sealing; relevant for Middle East market

CHAPTER 7

VSC Minimum Oil Flow Request

System-Level Flow Floor & Post-Drive Strategy

7.1 What Is a VSC Request?

The Vehicle System Controller (VSC) — sometimes called the VCU (Vehicle Control Unit) — is the top-level vehicle brain that coordinates all subsystems. It sends flow requests to the thermal management system, including the electric oil pump, based on system-level needs that go beyond what the motor torque and speed demand would require. The VSC minimum flow request acts as a hard floor below which the oil pump speed never falls, regardless of the torque/speed map output.

7.2 Reasons for Minimum Flow at Zero Operating Point

| Reason                  | Explanation                                                                                | Consequence If Not Met                                                     |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bearing lubrication     | Bearings need minimum oil film even at standstill to prevent dry start and excessive wear. | Increased wear, increased noise, and potential failure.                    |
| Seal conditioning       | Lip seals and O-rings require wetted contact to prevent leakage and cracking.              | Oil leakage, seal cracking, and increased leakage path formation.          |
| Thermal soak protection | After hard driving, motor is thermally hot. Oil must keep circulating to cool components.  | Overheating, increased wear, and potential failure.                        |
| Gear pre-lubrication    | Before first torque application, gear and shaft surfaces need oil to prevent scuffing.     | Increased wear, NVH, and potential failure.                                |
| Thermal model boundary  | Thermal observer in ECU needs stable oil flow to accurately model temperature.             | Model prediction error, leading to control application at rest.            |
| Post-drive run-on       | Driver switches off; pump continues running to cool components.                            | Insulation life, winding temperature, and component life risk for magnets. |

7.3 Typical VSC Minimum Flow Values

| Operating Condition                          | Min Oil Flow  | Approx Pump Speed | Duration                    |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------|-----------------------------|
| Ignition ON, cold, stationary                | 0.5–1.5 L/min | 200–500 RPM       | Until first drive           |
| Hot soak (T_winding > 80°C), vehicle stopped | 0.5–1.0 L/min | 500–1000 RPM      | Until T_winding < 60°C      |
| Post-drive run-on (ignition off)             | 1.0–2.0 L/min | 400–800 RPM       | 2–10 minutes                |
| Active driving, zero torque coasting         | 1.0–2.0 L/min | 400–800 RPM       | Continuous while moving     |
| Remote pre-conditioning (parked)             | 1.0 L/min     | 350–600 RPM       | Duration of preconditioning |
| Full performance demand                      | 6–10 L/min    | 2000–4000 RPM     | Duration of demand          |

7.4 Software Implementation

EOP Speed Arbitration – ECU Software

```
// EOP speed request arbitration (runs every 10 ms in thermal controller) float
torque_speed_req = lookup_2D(motor_torque_Nm, motor_speed_RPM); float thermal_req =
lookup_1D(MAX(T_winding_est, T_oil_sump)); float vsc_min_req =
CAN_receive(VSC_MIN_FLOW_RPM_signal); // Final command = highest of all requests (MAX wins)
float eop_target_rpm = MAX(torque_speed_req, thermal_req, vsc_min_req); // Apply rate limit
(prevents pump hunting) eop_target_rpm = rate_limit(eop_target_rpm, prev_rpm, MAX_RAMP_UP,
MAX_RAMP_DOWN); // Convert RPM to flow using pump curve interpolation float actual_flow =
interp_2D(pump_curve_table, eop_target_rpm, system_back_pressure_bar);
```

## CHAPTER 8

## Requirements Cascade

Vehicle Level → EDU Level → Motor & Cooling Requirements

## 8.1 The Cascade Process

Requirements cascade is the systematic process of translating high-level customer and regulatory needs into precise engineering specifications for each component. It is the most important systems engineering activity because every flow rate, temperature limit, and pump speed ultimately exists to fulfil a customer-facing vehicle requirement. Without traceability, a component engineer cannot know whether their specification is correct or whether a design change at component level will violate a vehicle-level promise.

### Example Cascade — 0 to 100 km/h Acceleration

#### Acceleration Requirement Cascade

VEHICLE REQUIREMENT: 0-100 km/h in 5.5 seconds Step 1 – Average acceleration:  $a_{avg} = (100/3.6) / 5.5 = 5.05 \text{ m/s}^2$  Step 2 – Peak tractive force at launch ( $M=2200 \text{ kg}$ ):  $F = 2200 \times 5.05 + F_{aero} + F_{rolling} = \sim 12,000 \text{ N}$  Step 3 – Wheel torque ( $R_{wheel} = 0.35 \text{ m}$ ):  $T_{wheel} = 12,000 \times 0.35 = 4,200 \text{ Nm}$  Step 4 – EDU output torque (final drive 9.5:1,  $\eta=0.97$ ):  $T_{EDU} = 4200 / (9.5 \times 0.97) = 456 \text{ Nm} \ll \text{EDU REQUIREMENT}$  Step 5 – EDU output speed at 100 km/h:  $\omega_{wheel} = (100/3.6) / 0.35 = 79.4 \text{ rad/s}$   $\omega_{EDU} = 79.4 \times 9.5 = 754 \text{ rad/s} = 7,200 \text{ RPM} \ll \text{EDU REQUIREMENT}$

## 8.2 EDU Level Requirements

| EDU Requirement               | Value                           | Derived From                      |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Peak output torque            | 456 Nm                          | 0–100 km/h in 5.5 s               |
| Peak output power             | ~250 kW                         | Top speed + grade target          |
| Continuous output torque      | 180 Nm                          | 20% grade at 80 km/h sustained    |
| Maximum output speed          | 8,500 RPM                       | 200 km/h top speed                |
| Peak duration                 | ≥ 30 seconds                    | Product requirement — launch feel |
| EDU efficiency (WLTP average) | ≥ 93%                           | 500 km range target               |
| Coolant inlet temperature max | 70°C                            | System thermal budget             |
| Oil sump temperature max      | 130°C                           | Sealed-for-life oil requirement   |
| No derating in WLTP           | Full cycle, any ambient to 40°C | Homologation requirement          |

## 8.3 Motor Level Requirements

| Motor Requirement | Value           | Derived From EDU Req         |
|-------------------|-----------------|------------------------------|
| Peak torque       | 350 Nm (≤ 10 s) | EDU peak torque ÷ gear ratio |



| Motor Requirement         | Value                         | Derived From EDU Req                 |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Continuous torque         | 160 Nm (steady state)         | EDU continuous ÷ gear ratio          |
| Peak power                | 230 kW                        | EDU peak power – inverter losses     |
| Maximum speed             | 16,000 RPM                    | EDU max speed × gear ratio           |
| Base speed (corner point) | 3,500 RPM                     | Motor design — MTPA/FW boundary      |
| Peak phase current        | 800 A <sub>peak</sub>         | Motor sizing from torque requirement |
| Continuous phase current  | 400 A <sub>rms</sub>          | Thermal model → continuous torque    |
| DC bus voltage            | 400 V or 800 V                | Platform architecture decision       |
| Winding temperature limit | 180°C continuous / 200°C peak | Insulation class selection           |
| Magnet temperature limit  | 120°C continuous / 140°C peak | Magnet grade N45SH properties        |
| Coolant inlet temp max    | 70°C                          | EDU level requirement                |
| Oil inlet temp max        | 90°C                          | Sump + HEX thermal budget            |
| Minimum coolant flow      | 10 L/min                      | Heat rejection capacity calc         |
| Minimum oil flow          | 3 L/min                       | End winding temp at continuous       |
| Peak motor efficiency     | ≥ 96%                         | EDU efficiency budget                |

## 8.4 Thermal Budget Allocation

The total heat rejection budget for the EDU is the product of maximum input power and the complement of EDU efficiency. This budget must be allocated across all loss sources, and the cooling system sized to reject each allocation.

### Thermal Budget & Flow Requirement Derivation

Total heat rejection budget:  $P_{\text{loss\_total}} = P_{\text{input}} \times (1 - \eta_{\text{EDU}}) = 250 \text{ kW} \times (1 - 0.93) = 17,500 \text{ W}$   
 Loss allocation: Motor copper loss ~6,000 W (34%) Motor iron loss ~2,500 W (14%)  
 Inverter switching loss ~3,500 W (20%) Inverter conduction loss ~2,000 W (11%) Gearbox mesh loss ~2,000 W (11%) Bearing + windage loss ~1,500 W (9%) ----- Total 17,500 W  
 Coolant circuit rejection (inverter + stator jacket):  $P_{\text{coolant}} = 3,500 + 2,000 + 6,000 \times 0.4 = \sim 8,000 \text{ W}$   
 $Q_{\text{coolant}} = 8,000 / (1060 \times 3600 \times 10) = 12.6 \text{ L/min} \rightarrow \text{spec: } 13 \text{ L/min}$   
 Oil circuit rejection (end winding + rotor + gear + bearing):  $P_{\text{oil}} = 6,000 \times 0.6 + 2,500 + 2,000 + 1,500 = \sim 9,600 \text{ W}$   
 $Q_{\text{oil}} = 9,600 / (870 \times 2000 \times 15) = 3.7 \text{ L/min} \rightarrow \text{spec: } 4 \text{ L/min minimum}$

CHAPTER 9

# V-Model Verification & Test Planning

From Component Bench to Vehicle Validation

## 9.1 The V-Model Structure

The V-model is the governing framework for systems engineering verification and validation. Requirements are decomposed down the left side of the V, and verification evidence closes back up the right side. Every requirement written during design must have a corresponding verification method and test result. The model ensures that component-level test results can be traced all the way back to the original vehicle-level customer promise.

V-Model Structure

LEFT SIDE (Requirements Decomposition) Vehicle Requirements | EDU Requirements | Motor / Inverter Requirements | Cooling System Specification | Component Specification (pump, HEX)  
RIGHT SIDE (Verification Closure – mirror image) Component Bench Test <- validates component spec  
Motor Dyno Test <- validates motor requirements  
EDU Integration Test <- validates EDU requirements  
Vehicle Level Test <- validates vehicle requirements

## 9.2 Component Bench Tests

### Oil Pump H-Q Curve Test

Oil Pump Verification Test

Objective: Validate pressure-flow characteristic at each RPM and temperature  
Setup: Pump on calibrated flow bench  
Flow meter (Coriolis or electromagnetic)  
Pressure transducers: inlet and outlet  
Oil bath at controlled temperature: 40, 80, 100 degC  
Test matrix: RPM: 500, 1000, 1500, 2000, 2500, 3000  
Back pressure: 0.5, 1.0, 1.5, 2.0, 3.0 bar  
Temperature: 40, 80, 100 degC  
Pass criteria: Flow at 2000 RPM, 1.5 bar >= 6 L/min (per requirement)  
Volumetric efficiency >= 85% at nominal operating point  
Flow degradation < 5% after 200,000 km equivalent duty

### Heat Exchanger Effectiveness Test

HEX Effectiveness Test

Key metric: Thermal effectiveness  
 $\epsilon = \frac{Q_{actual}}{Q_{maximum}}$   
 $Q_{max} = C_{min} \times (T_{hot\_in} - T_{cold\_in})$   
 $C_{min} = \min(m_{oil} \times Cp_{oil}, m_{coolant} \times Cp_{coolant})$   
Pass criteria:  $\epsilon \geq 0.75$  at nominal flow conditions  
Oil-side pressure drop <= 0.3 bar at max flow  
Coolant-side pressure drop <= 0.2 bar at max flow  
No degradation after 1000-hour thermal cycling test

## 9.3 Motor Component Tests Summary

| Test ID | Test Name         | Key Measurement                                         | Pass Criterion                       |
|---------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| MT-2A   | Thermal Mapping   | T_winding, T_magnet, T_housing at 2000 RPM steady state | Max winding temp < 155°C             |
| MT-2B   | Continuous Rating | T_winding at thermal equilibrium, continuous            | T_winding < 175°C at 70°C coolant in |
| MT-2C   | Peak Duration     | Time from cold/hot to derate activation                 | Cold peak ≥ 30 s; hot peak ≥ 10 s    |

| Test ID | Test Name            | Key Measurement                             | Pass Criterion                               |
|---------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| MT-2D   | Oil Flow Sensitivity | T_winding vs oil flow rate                  | Min flow requirement established with margin |
| MT-2E   | Derating Validation  | Torque vs T_winding trajectory              | No temperature overshoot beyond T_derate_end |
| MT-2F   | Loss Mapping         | P_input – P_output at every operating point | loss map accuracy ±2% for ECU observer input |

9.4 Requirements Traceability Matrix

| Requirement          | Target Value            | Test ID         | Test Level    | Status  |
|----------------------|-------------------------|-----------------|---------------|---------|
| Continuous torque    | 160 Nm, T<180°C         | MT-2B           | Motor         | PASS    |
| Peak torque duration | 350 Nm ≥ 30 s           | MT-2C           | Motor         | PASS    |
| Minimum oil flow     | 3 L/min at continuous   | MT-2D / ET-3A   | Motor / EDU   | PASS    |
| No WLTP derating     | Full 23-min cycle       | ET-3B / VT-4A   | EDU / Vehicle | PASS    |
| Hot ambient grade    | 45°C, no derate         | VT-4B / VT-4C   | Vehicle / PG  | ONGOING |
| Cold start priming   | <5 s at –20°C           | VT-4B           | Vehicle       | PLANNED |
| Oil lifetime         | Sealed for life 200k km | OAT-001 / Fleet | Lab / Fleet   | ONGOING |

## CHAPTER 10

## Thermal Model Calibration

*LPTN Parameter Estimation from Test Data*

## 10.1 The ECU Thermal Observer

The motor thermal model runs inside the ECU in real time at a loop rate of 10–50 ms. In production vehicles, there are no thermocouples in the windings — the ECU model is the only source of winding temperature information. This makes calibration accuracy safety-critical: if the model underestimates winding temperature by 10°C, derating activates too late and insulation damage accumulates. If it overestimates by 10°C, performance is unnecessarily restricted.

**ECU Observer Architecture**

ECU THERMAL OBSERVER Measurable inputs (available in production): I\_phase\_rms (from inverter current sensors) Motor\_speed\_RPM (from resolver / encoder) T\_coolant\_in (from coolant NTC sensor) T\_oil\_in (from oil NTC sensor) V\_dc\_bus (from HV system) Estimated outputs (not directly measured in production): T\_copper\_hotspot -> input to winding derate logic T\_magnet -> input to magnet derate / current limit T\_bearing -> input to bearing protection logic Model update rate: every 10-50 ms Model complexity: 6-10 thermal nodes (balance accuracy vs CPU load)

## 10.2 Loss Map Generation — Critical First Step

Before any thermal calibration can begin, an accurate loss map must be measured. The loss map defines how much heat is generated at every operating point — it is the heat source input to the LPTN. An error in the loss map creates a systematic error in all thermal predictions regardless of how well the R and C values are tuned.

**Loss Map Measurement**

Loss measurement at each (torque, speed) point:  $P_{\text{loss}} = P_{\text{electrical\_in}} - P_{\text{mechanical\_out}} = (V_{\text{dc}} \times I_{\text{dc}}) - (\text{Torque} \times \omega)$  Loss segregation:  $P_{\text{copper}} = I_{\text{rms}}^2 \times R_{\text{dc}} \times K_{\text{ac}} \times (1 + \alpha \times \Delta T)$   $P_{\text{iron}} = P_{\text{loss\_total}} - P_{\text{copper}} - P_{\text{mechanical}}$   $P_{\text{mech}} = P_{\text{loss}}$  measured at zero current (friction + windage) Temperature correction (CRITICAL):  $R_{\text{copper}}$  at 180 degC =  $R_{20} \times (1 + 0.00393 \times 160) = 1.63 \times R_{20}$  Copper losses at hot conditions are 63% higher than cold! Loss map must be 3D:  $f(\text{torque, speed, temperature})$

## 10.3 Steady State R Calibration

**R Calibration Optimisation**

Using steady-state thermal map test data to solve for R values: R4 (housing to coolant):  $R_4 = (T_{\text{housing\_measured}} - T_{\text{coolant\_in}}) / P_{\text{stator\_total}}$  R\_total (copper to coolant, combined):  $R_{\text{total}} = (T_{\text{winding\_measured}} - T_{\text{coolant\_in}}) / P_{\text{copper}}$  R6 (end winding to oil – flow dependent): Calibrate as 2D table:  $R_6 = f(Q_{\text{oil}}, T_{\text{oil}})$  At each oil flow test point:  $R_6 = (T_{\text{endwinding}} - T_{\text{oil\_in}}) / P_{\text{endwinding}}$  Optimisation approach: Minimise:  $\sum_i (T_{\text{predicted\_i}} - T_{\text{measured\_i}})^2$  Optimise: [R1, R2, R3, R4, R5, R6, R7, R8] Constraints:  $R > 0$ , within +/-50% of theoretical Tools: MATLAB fmincon, Python scipy.optimize.minimize

## 10.4 Transient C Calibration

R values control steady-state accuracy. C values control transient accuracy — how fast temperatures rise after a load step. C calibration uses step-load transient test data and requires matching the temperature

trajectory, not just the final value.

Transient C Calibration

Transient test procedure: 1. Motor at thermal equilibrium at light load 2. Instant step change to high torque 3. Record T\_winding every 1 second 4. Tune C values until model matches measured trajectory Physical values (starting point before tuning): C\_copper = m\_copper x Cp\_copper (Cp = 385 J/kg.K – well known) C\_stator = m\_iron x Cp\_iron (Cp\_iron = 460 J/kg.K) + m\_insulation x Cp\_insulation C\_housing = m\_housing x Cp\_aluminium (Cp\_al = 900 J/kg.K) Common calibration finding: Effective C\_stator < theoretical due to imperfect thermal contact between laminations – tune by 10-30% reduction

10.5 Model Validation Acceptance Criteria

| Validation Metric               | Acceptance Criterion   | Why This Matters                                           |
|---------------------------------|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| T_winding steady state accuracy | ±5°C vs measured       | Directly sets derate threshold margin                      |
| T_magnet steady state accuracy  | ±8°C vs measured       | Demagnetisation risk assessment                            |
| T_housing steady state accuracy | ±3°C vs measured       | Housing is a reference node — errors propagate             |
| Transient trajectory error      | ±8°C at any time point | Peak prediction accuracy — drives derate activation timing |
| Drive cycle RMS error (WLTP)    | <4°C over full cycle   | System-level model validity                                |
| Drive cycle peak error          | <±5°C at any peak      | Most critical — peak drives hardware limits                |

## CHAPTER 11

## Derating Calibration

*Setting Thresholds, Slopes, Rate Limits & Hysteresis*

## 11.1 Why Derating Calibration Is Critical

Derating calibration is the process of setting the precise temperature thresholds, torque reduction slopes, rate limits, and hysteresis values that govern how the motor controller reduces output when thermal limits are approached. It is a safety-critical calibration because an error in either direction has serious consequences.

| Calibration Error Direction        | Consequence                                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Too aggressive (derate too early)  | Performance unnecessarily restricted; customer complaint 'car feels slow when warm'; competitive disadvantage |
| Too conservative (derate too late) | Winding temperature exceeds insulation class limit; accelerated aging; possible catastrophic failure          |

## 11.2 Two-Zone Derate Map

### Derate Map Structure

Torque limit as function of estimated winding temperature:  $T_{winding} < T_{derate\_start}$ :  
 $Torque\_limit = 100\%$  (no restriction)  $T_{derate\_start} \leq T \leq T_{derate\_end}$ : Linear reduction  
 $T_{winding} > T_{derate\_end}$ :  $Torque\_limit = 0\%$  (full derate)  $Torque\_limit(\%) = 100 \times (T_{derate\_end} - T_{winding}) / (T_{derate\_end} - T_{derate\_start})$  Typical values (Class H motor):  $T_{derate\_start} = 160 \text{ degC}$   $T_{derate\_end} = 175 \text{ degC}$  Recovery temp =  $145 \text{ degC}$  (hysteresis – see Section 11.4)

## 11.3 Setting $T_{derate\_end}$

### $T_{derate\_end}$ Calibration

$T_{derate\_end} = T_{insulation\_class} - \text{Safety\_margin}$  Insulation classes: Class F:  $155 \text{ degC}$  rated continuous Class H:  $180 \text{ degC}$  rated continuous Class C:  $>180 \text{ degC}$  rated continuous Safety margin sources: Model prediction error:  $\pm 5$  to  $8 \text{ degC}$  -> margin needed Sensor/input uncertainty:  $\pm 2$  to  $3 \text{ degC}$  -> margin needed Aging factor (end of life): insulation degrades -> extra margin Regulatory safety factor: programme-specific Typical result for Class H motor:  $T_{derate\_end} = 170$  to  $175 \text{ degC}$  ( $180 \text{ degC}$  rated minus  $5$ - $10 \text{ degC}$  model uncertainty margin) Magnet derate end (separate limit):  $T_{demag}$  (N45SH at zero current) =  $180 \text{ degC}$   $T_{demag}$  (N45SH at peak FW current) =  $120 \text{ degC}$   $T_{derate\_end\_magnet} = 130$  to  $140 \text{ degC}$

## 11.4 Setting $T_{derate\_start}$

### $T_{derate\_start}$ Simulation Method

$T_{derate\_start}$  is set by simulation – not by static analysis alone. Simulation approach: Scenario: Motor at  $T_{derate\_start}$ , full peak torque applied Question: Does temperature exceed  $T_{derate\_end}$  before torque reaches zero? Calculate temperature rise rate at peak torque:  $dT/dt = P_{loss\_peak} / C_{thermal\_effective}$  Example:  $P_{loss}$  at peak torque =  $8,000 \text{ W}$   $C_{effective}$  (copper + stator iron) =  $15,000 \text{ J/degC}$   $dT/dt = 8000 / 15000 = 0.53 \text{ degC/s}$  Time available before  $T_{derate\_end}$  is reached:  $t_{available} = (T_{derate\_end} - T_{derate\_start}) / (dT/dt) = (175 - 160) / 0.53 = 28 \text{ seconds}$  With rate-limited derate ( $Nm/s$  limit), verify torque reaches zero before  $T$  exceeds  $T_{derate\_end}$  in simulation. If not -> lower  $T_{derate\_start}$ .

## 11.5 Multi-Dimensional Derating Arbitration

### Full Arbitration Logic

```
Final torque limit = MIN of all contributing limits: Torque_limit_winding =
f(T_winding_estimated) // insulation Torque_limit_magnet = f(T_magnet_estimated) // demag
Current_limit_FW = f(T_magnet, RPM) // FW demag Torque_limit_inverter = f(T_junction_estimated)
// IGBT/SiC Torque_limit_current = f(I_phase_limit(temp)) // current Torque_limit_voltage =
f(V_dc, RPM) // flux Torque_limit_bearing = f(T_bearing_estimated) // bearing Torque_limit_oil
= f(T_oil_sump) // oil FINAL = MIN(all_above)
```

## 11.6 Rate Limiting & Hysteresis

Rate limiting prevents the sudden torque steps that would cause dangerous vehicle lurching. Hysteresis prevents hunting (oscillation in and out of derate). Both must be co-calibrated to ensure the hardware is protected without compromising the stability of the derate control strategy.

### Rate Limiting & Hysteresis Calibration

Rate Limiting: Maximum derate rate: -50 Nm/s (negative = reducing) From 350 Nm to 0 Nm: minimum 7 seconds Maximum recovery rate: +20 Nm/s (gentler than derate) Verification:  $dT/dt \times t_{\text{ramp\_down}} < \Delta T_{\text{available}}$  Example:  $0.53 \text{ degC/s} \times 7\text{s} = 3.7 \text{ degC}$  rise during ramp  $3.7 < (175 - 160) = 15 \text{ degC}$  -> safe with margin Hysteresis: Derate activates at:  $T_{\text{derate\_start}} = 160 \text{ degC}$  Derate fully removed:  $T_{\text{recovery}} = 145 \text{ degC}$  Gap = 15 degC prevents hunting between active/inactive states WITHOUT hysteresis: temperature oscillates either side of  $T_{\text{derate\_start}}$  causing repeated torque steps -> driveability issue

CHAPTER 12

Oil Lifetime Profile

Degradation Mechanisms, Calculation & Testing

12.1 Why EV Oil Lifetime Is Uniquely Challenging

EV powertrain oil faces a unique combination of stresses not encountered in conventional ICE transmissions. Most significantly, many modern EV EDU designs are sealed-for-life — meaning the factory-filled oil must survive the entire vehicle service life of 200,000 km and 15+ years with no oil change. This makes the oil lifetime analysis a direct input to the cooling system design requirement.

| Stress Factor           | ICE Transmission                 | EV Powertrain                                   |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Electrical stress       | None (no live conductors in oil) | HIGH — copper windings bathed in oil            |
| Operating speed         | Moderate (<6,000 RPM gears)      | VERY HIGH (shaft to 20,000 RPM)                 |
| Thermal load            | Moderate, cyclic                 | High, sustained at peak performance             |
| Service interval        | 60,000–100,000 km                | Sealed for life (no drain plug in many designs) |
| Contamination           | Combustion products (soot, fuel) | Copper ions, insulation particles, wear metals  |
| Electrical conductivity | Not a concern                    | Critical — must remain low throughout life      |

12.2 The Five Degradation Mechanisms

1 — Thermal Oxidation (Primary)

Thermal oxidation is the dominant oil degradation mode. At elevated temperatures, oil molecules react with dissolved oxygen in a chain reaction that produces acidic byproducts, varnish, and sludge. The Arrhenius relationship means that every 10°C increase in oil temperature approximately doubles the oxidation rate — making sump temperature control a direct life-of-oil requirement.

**Arrhenius Oxidation Rate: Rate doubles every ~10 degC rise**  
At 100 degC: oil life = L (reference)  
At 110 degC: oil life = L/2  
At 120 degC: oil life = L/4  
At 130 degC: oil life = L/8  
At 140 degC: oil life = L/16

2 — Electrical Degradation (EV-Specific)

| Electrical Mechanism            | Description                                           | Consequence                                               |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Electrostatic discharge erosion | EVW inverter creates shaft voltage → bearing currents | Discharge through oil film → pitting, surface degradation |
| Copper ion dissolution          | Copper dissolves from winding surfaces                | Oxidation, catalyst poisoning, increased viscosity        |
| Conductivity increase           | Degraded oil becomes more electrically conductive     | Current leakage paths; insulation risk                    |
| Additive electrolysis           | Polar additive molecules migrate under electric field | Active additives depleted at critical surfaces            |



### 3 — Mechanical Shear Degradation

High-speed gear mesh and bearing contacts mechanically shear long-chain polymer additives (viscosity index improvers) in the oil, causing permanent viscosity loss. As viscosity drops, the elastohydrodynamic (EHD) oil film thickness at gear teeth and bearing contacts reduces, increasing metal-to-metal contact and wear rate.

Oil film thickness (simplified EHD):  $h_{\text{film}}$  proportional to  $(\eta \times \text{speed}) / \text{load}$   
If viscosity ( $\eta$ ) drops by 20% due to shear: Film thickness drops by ~20% Wear rate increases exponentially below critical film thickness KRL Shear Test (CEC L-45): EV oil requirement: viscosity loss < 10% after 20 hours

### 4 — Hydrolysis (Water Contamination)

Water enters the oil circuit through condensation during thermal cycling, seal permeation over time, and residual manufacturing moisture. Water reacts with additives causing hydrolysis, rust, emulsification, and — most critically for EVs — forms copper hydroxide with dissolved copper ions, which strongly accelerates oxidation. Water content must be kept below 200 ppm.

### 5 — Particle Contamination

| Particle Size      | Effect                                      | Source                                                 |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| >10 $\mu\text{m}$  | Direct bearing damage — three-body abrasion | Seal wear, bearing wear debris, assembly contamination |
| 1–10 $\mu\text{m}$ | Accelerated surface fatigue — micropitting  | Seal wear, oxidation products                          |
| <1 $\mu\text{m}$   | Catalytic acceleration of oxidation         | Insulation particles, very fine wear debris            |

## 12.3 Arrhenius Lifetime Calculation

The oil lifetime calculation uses the Arrhenius damage accumulation model. The vehicle mission profile defines how many hours the oil spends at each temperature, and the oil supplier provides oxidation life data at reference temperatures. Cumulative damage is calculated using Miner's rule — the same approach used for structural fatigue life prediction.

#### Lifetime Damage Calculation

Cumulative damage model:  $D_{\text{total}} = \sum_i (t_i / L_i)$   $t_i$  = hours spent at temperature  $T_i$  (from mission profile simulation)  $L_i$  = oil life at constant temperature  $T_i$  (from supplier data) Oil FAILS when  $D_{\text{total}} = 1.0$  Example calculation (oil life at 100 degC = 8,000 hours):  $T = 80 \text{ degC}$ : 3000 hrs / 32000 hrs = 0.094 damage  $T = 100 \text{ degC}$ : 2000 hrs / 8000 hrs = 0.250 damage  $T = 110 \text{ degC}$ : 1000 hrs / 4000 hrs = 0.250 damage  $T = 120 \text{ degC}$ : 500 hrs / 2000 hrs = 0.250 damage  $T = 130 \text{ degC}$ : 200 hrs / 1000 hrs = 0.200 damage  $T = 140 \text{ degC}$ : 50 hrs / 500 hrs = 0.100 damage -----  $D_{\text{total}} = 1.144 > 1.0 \rightarrow$  OIL FAILS before end of vehicle life Action required: Reduce sump temperature OR specify higher grade oil

## 12.4 How Oil Lifetime Drives Cooling Design

#### Oil Lifetime → Cooling Specification Chain

Oil lifetime requirement (sealed for life, 200k km) | V Arrhenius calculation: Oil fails if  $T_{\text{sump\_max}} > 130 \text{ degC}$  for defined hour distribution | V Thermal model of sump:  $T_{\text{sump}} = f(P_{\text{loss}}, Q_{\text{oil}}, T_{\text{oil\_in}}, T_{\text{ambient}})$  | V Oil cooler sizing requirement: Must keep  $T_{\text{sump}} < 125 \text{ degC}$  (5 degC margin) at worst case: - Maximum power demand - 45 degC ambient - Maximum grade climb | V YOUR SPECIFICATIONS: Oil cooler UA value (W/K) Oil flow rate through cooler (L/min) Coolant temperature at cooler inlet (degC)

## 12.5 Oil Selection Criteria Summary

| Property                | Requirement                           | Reason                                                      |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| SAE Grade               | 0W-20 or 0W-16                        | Low viscosity for efficiency; wide temp range operation     |
| Base oil type           | Group III or Group IV (PAO) synthetic | Oxidation resistance; shear stability; low-temp pumpability |
| Thermal stability       | Oxidation resistance to 130°C+        | Sealed-for-life requirement                                 |
| Electrical conductivity | <1000 pS/m throughout life            | Prevent current leakage paths near live conductors          |
| Copper corrosion        | No Cu corrosion (Cu strip test pass)  | Copper dissolution accelerates oxidation                    |
| Shear stability         | Viscosity loss <10% (KRL test)        | Maintain EHD film over vehicle life                         |
| Pour point              | <-45°C                                | Cold start pumpability at -40°C ambient                     |
| Foam control            | Anti-foam additives essential         | High-speed churning generates foam — disrupts cooling       |
| Seal compatibility      | No swell/shrink of FKM, HNBR          | Seal integrity over vehicle life                            |
| EP additives            | Compatible with copper — no S or Pb   | Standard GL-4/5 EP additives attack copper                  |

CHAPTER 13

Stator Winding Temperature

Insulation System, Ageing, Performance Effects & Measurement

13.1 The Slot Structure & Hot Spot

The stator winding hot spot is the single most important temperature in the entire EV powertrain thermal system. It is the temperature at the innermost copper conductor in the deepest slot — the furthest point from any cooling surface. It is never directly measured in production vehicles; the ECU thermal observer estimates it from measurable boundary conditions. All insulation life calculations and derate thresholds refer to this hot spot temperature.

Slot Thermal Resistance Chain

Slot thermal resistance chain: [Copper conductor] -- R\_enamel --> [Slot varnish/potting] -- R\_slot\_liner --> [Stator tooth iron] -- R\_tooth --> [Stator yoke] -- R\_yoke\_housing --> [Housing wall] -- R\_housing\_coolant --> [Coolant] Thermal conductivities: Copper: 400 W/m.K (excellent conductor) Epoxy impregnation: 0.2-1.0 W/m.K (moderate – fills voids) Slot liner (Nomex/Kapton): 0.15-0.25 W/m.K (BOTTLENECK) Silicon steel: 25-40 W/m.K (good conductor) Aluminium housing: 150-200 W/m.K (good conductor) Slot liner is the dominant resistance: Even 0.2 mm thickness at 0.2 W/m.K creates significant delta\_T This is why end-winding oil spray is so thermally valuable: it bypasses the slot liner resistance entirely

13.2 Insulation System Components

| Layer                | Material                 | Thickness       | Function                                  | Failure Mode                                     |
|----------------------|--------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Conductor enamel     | Polyimide (PI) or PAI    | 30–80 µm        | Isolate conductors from each other        | Turn-to-turn short circuit                       |
| Slot liner           | Nomex or Kapton film     | 0.2–0.5 mm      | Isolate winding from stator iron          | Winding-to-ground fault                          |
| Phase separator      | Nomex paper              | 0.2–0.3 mm      | Separate phase conductors in slots        | Phase-to-phase arc fault                         |
| Impregnation varnish | Epoxy or polyester resin | Fills all voids | Mechanical bonding + thermal conductivity | Cracking → moisture ingress → insulation failure |

13.3 Thermal Ageing — The Montsinger Rule

Insulation does not fail instantly when its class temperature is exceeded. It undergoes cumulative thermal ageing — an irreversible chemical degradation that progressively reduces dielectric strength and mechanical properties. This ageing follows Arrhenius kinetics, described practically by the Montsinger Rule.

**Montsinger Rule:** 'Every 10 degC rise in operating temperature halves insulation life' Arrhenius form:  $L(T) = L_{ref} \times \exp\left(\frac{E_a}{R} \times \left(\frac{1}{T} - \frac{1}{T_{ref}}\right)\right)$   $L_{ref}$  = insulation life at reference temperature  $E_a$  = activation energy (~1.0-1.4 eV for polyimide)  $T$  = operating temperature (Kelvin) Class H example ( $L_{ref}$  = 20,000 hrs at 180 degC): At 170 degC -> life = 40,000 hrs (2x longer) At 160 degC -> life = 80,000 hrs (4x longer) At 190 degC -> life = 10,000 hrs (2x shorter) At 200 degC -> life = 5,000 hrs (4x shorter)

### 13.4 Effect of Winding Temperature on Motor Performance

Winding temperature affects motor performance in multiple ways, all of which are thermally coupled — creating a positive feedback loop that must be managed by the derating strategy.

Temperature Effects on Motor Performance

Copper resistance temperature dependence:  $R(T) = R_{20} \times (1 + \alpha \times (T - 20))$   $\alpha_{copper} = 0.00393$  per degC  
At 20 degC:  $R = R_{20}$  (reference)  
At 100 degC:  $R = 1.31 \times R_{20}$  (+31%)  
At 150 degC:  $R = 1.51 \times R_{20}$  (+51%)  
At 180 degC:  $R = 1.63 \times R_{20}$  (+63%)  
Consequences:  
1. Copper losses INCREASE with temperature  $P_{copper} = I^2 \times R \rightarrow$  more heat at same current  $\rightarrow$  thermal runaway risk  
2. Torque constant  $K_t$  DECREASES slightly (resistance affects dynamic) Same current  $\rightarrow$  less effective torque production  
3. Field weakening speed REDUCES at hot conditions  $V_{dc} = E_{back} + I \times R + I \times L \times \omega$  Higher R  $\rightarrow$  less voltage headroom  $\rightarrow$  FW starts at lower speed  
Customer notices reduced top speed / high speed acceleration when hot

### 13.5 Winding Temperature — Key Threshold Values

| Temperature | Significance                                                                                 |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 20°C        | Cold soak reference — calibration baseline; maximum copper resistance accuracy               |
| 60°C        | Oil typically reaches this temperature before motor on warm-up; VSC may allow full torque    |
| 100°C       | Copper resistance 31% above cold; efficiency measurably lower; normal operating range        |
| 130°C       | Typical steady-state at aggressive but normal driving; continuous operation target           |
| 155°C       | Class F insulation rated limit; derate warning zone in older motor designs                   |
| 160°C       | Typical $T_{derate\_start}$ for Class H motor; controlled torque reduction begins            |
| 175°C       | Typical $T_{derate\_end}$ ; full torque removal; model uncertainty margin before class limit |
| 180°C       | Class H continuous rated limit; NOT to be exceeded in normal operation under any condition   |
| 200°C       | Short-term absolute maximum; insulation survives briefly; life significantly consumed        |
| 220°C+      | Irreversible insulation damage; slot liner breakdown risk; immediate hardware failure risk   |

### 13.6 Measurement Methods in Development

| Method                      | What It Measures                          | Advantages                                            | Limitations                                                |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Embedded thermocouples      | Type K temperature inside slot (Type K)   | Direct measurement, fast response                     | Can't see spatial coverage with multiple sensors           |
| Resistance Temperature (DC) | Average copper temperature (average temp) | True average temp, DC resistance                      | Not locally ringed, not real-time; slow                    |
| Infrared thermal camera     | End winding surface temperature           | Spatial distribution map; identifies hot spots        | Stiffness on hot spots not obvious; emissivity calibration |
| Fibre optic sensor          | Point temperature inside slot             | High accuracy, immune to electromagnetic interference | Expensive, requires special slot preparation               |

## CHAPTER 14

## Rotor &amp; Magnet Temperature

*Demagnetisation Risk, Cooling Strategies & Thermal Coupling*

## 14.1 Why the Rotor Is the Harder Thermal Problem

Despite often generating less total heat than the stator, the rotor presents a fundamentally harder thermal problem for three reasons: it rotates at up to 20,000 RPM making direct coolant access impossible; the thermal resistance from magnet to coolant is 5–10 times higher than from stator winding to coolant; and the long thermal time constant means rotor temperature can continue rising for minutes after electrical load is removed — the thermal soak phenomenon.

### Rotor Thermal Problem

Rotor heat path (every arrow is a thermal resistance): [Magnet] -> [Rotor iron] -> [Shaft] -> [Bearing] -> [Housing] -> [Coolant] Comparison: Stator thermal resistance (winding to coolant): ~5-15 K/kW Rotor thermal resistance (magnet to coolant): ~30-80 K/kW Rotor thermal time constant: 100-500 seconds Stator thermal time constant: 30-120 seconds Result: Rotor temperature rises SLOWLY but KEEPS RISING even after electrical load is removed. Post-drive thermal soak is critical consequence.

## 14.2 Magnet Properties vs Temperature

NdFeB (Neodymium Iron Boron) permanent magnets are used in virtually all high-performance EV traction motors. Their magnetic properties — remanence  $B_r$  and coercivity  $H_{ci}$  — both degrade with temperature. Critically, coercivity (the demagnetisation resistance) is far more temperature-sensitive than remanence.

Remanence temperature coefficient:  $B_r(T) = B_{r\_20} \times (1 + \alpha_{Br} \times (T - 20))$   
 $\alpha_{Br}$  (NdFeB) = -0.11 %/degC Coercivity temperature coefficient:  $H_{ci}(T) = H_{ci\_20} \times (1 + \alpha_{Hci} \times (T - 20))$   $\alpha_{Hci}$  (NdFeB) = -0.55 %/degC (5x more sensitive!) At 140 degC vs 20 degC:  $B_r$  reduction:  $0.11\% \times 120 = 13.2\%$  -> torque drops ~13%  $H_{ci}$  reduction:  $0.55\% \times 120 = 66\%$  -> demag resistance SEVERELY compromised

## 14.3 Demagnetisation — The Irreversible Failure Mode

Demagnetisation is the most feared failure in EV motor design. Unlike insulation degradation which is gradual and potentially detectable, demagnetisation can be sudden and leaves the motor permanently damaged with reduced torque capability that cannot be restored by any repair short of magnet replacement.

### Demagnetisation Conditions

Two conditions cause irreversible demagnetisation: Condition 1 – High Temperature Alone:  $H_{ci}$  decreases -> knee point of B-H curve rises Even without high current, magnet operating point can cross knee point at elevated temperature. Defines:  $T_{demag\_limit}$  (material property of magnet grade) Condition 2 – High Current + Elevated Temperature: During field weakening operation, large negative d-axis current creates demagnetising field opposing the magnet. At elevated temperature (low  $H_{ci}$ ), this field can exceed the knee point -> partial or full demagnetisation. Most critical during: - High speed operation (field weakening region) - Short circuit fault current event - Peak torque demand when rotor already hot Consequence of partial demagnetisation: 5-20% permanent torque reduction Customer experiences: 'car feels permanently less powerful' Cannot be repaired – motor replacement required Significant warranty cost and customer satisfaction impact

## 14.4 Magnet Temperature Thresholds

| Temperature | Significance for NdFeB N45SH Grade                                                         |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 20°C        | Reference: Br = 1.35 T, Hci = 1600 kA/m — full magnetic properties                         |
| 80°C        | Br reduced ~7%, Hci reduced ~33% — still safe, normal operating range                      |
| 100°C       | Br reduced ~9%, Hci reduced ~44% — elevated; field weakening demag risk rising             |
| 110°C       | T_derate_start_magnet — begin reducing peak current, especially in field weakening         |
| 120°C       | Hci reduced ~55% — significant; current limits must be strictly enforced; continuous limit |
| 130°C       | T_derate_end_magnet — maximum current sharply reduced; FW capability severely limited      |
| 150°C       | Absolute maximum N45SH — irreversible demagnetisation risk at any operating current        |
| 180°C+      | Approaching Curie temperature — complete loss of magnetic ordering; catastrophic failure   |

## 14.5 Rotor Cooling Strategies

| Strategy            | Description                                                                    | Thermal Effectiveness      | Design Challenge                                   |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Shaft oil feed      | Oil pumped through hollow shaft; centrifugal distribution                      | High for central area      | Sealing at input/output; high-speed distribution   |
| End plate oil spray | Oil jets directed at rotor end faces, cooling DFB and winding axial conduction | Medium                     | Oil leakage; high RPM; coverage                    |
| Air gap oil mist    | Forced oil mist through air gap; Hci reduced on surface                        | High (retained on surface) | Major winding loss increase; foam generation; air  |
| Passive conduction  | Rotor heat → air gap convection → stator                                       | Low                        | Stack ground path only — not a primary cooling str |

## 14.6 Stator-Rotor Thermal Coupling

Stator and rotor temperatures are not independent — they are thermally coupled through the air gap. This coupling is often underestimated in simplified thermal models and can lead to significant prediction errors, particularly at operating conditions where both stator and rotor are simultaneously hot.

**Air gap heat transfer:**  $Q_{\text{airgap}} = h_{\text{airgap}} \times A_{\text{airgap}} \times (T_{\text{stator\_inner}} - T_{\text{rotor\_outer}})$   
**Air gap convection coefficient  $h_{\text{airgap}}$ :** Low speed (<1000 RPM):  $h = 50\text{-}100 \text{ W/m}^2\text{.K}$  (conduction dominated)  
High speed (>10000 RPM):  $h = 200\text{-}500 \text{ W/m}^2\text{.K}$  (Taylor-Couette turbulent)  
**Critical coupling scenario:** Stator hot (high torque) AND rotor hot (high speed) -> Air gap can transfer heat FROM rotor TO stator or vice versa -> Rotor thermal model MUST include this coupling term -> Omitting it causes systematic rotor temperature underestimation

## 14.7 Operating Condition vs Thermal Risk Summary

| Operating Condition                      | Primary Thermal Risk | Reason                                        | Cooling Priority                                       |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Low speed, high torque (launch/haul)     | STATOR WINDING       | High I²R; low air gap convection              | Maximize oil flow distribution; winding spray critical |
| High speed, light load (motorway cruise) | ROTOR MAGNET         | High iron losses at high electrical frequency | Stator fan; immediate current limiting; winding spray  |

| Operating Condition                   | Primary Thermal Risk  | Reason                                                                                           | Cooling Priority                                          |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| High speed, high torque (performance) | BOTH                  | Simultaneously Maximum losses everywhere; worst case combined condition                          | Maximize combined cooling                                 |
| Regenerative braking                  | Usually LOW — monitor | Current flows but energy recovered; Sootless? Rn maintained; no extra demand                     | VS. chasis? Rn                                            |
| Stationary with torque (hill hold)    | STATOR — worst case   | Zero speed; zero windage; sustained maximum current; oil flow centrifugal close by at line-limit | Max current, oil flow, centrifugal close by at line-limit |
| Post-drive thermal soak               | ROTOR MAGNET          | Long rotor time constant; temperature after load pumping                                         | Post-drive after-load pumping essential                   |

## CHAPTER 15

## Quick Reference Tables

*Key Numbers, Constants & Engineering Rules of Thumb*

## 15.1 Key System Performance Numbers

| Parameter                              | Typical Value  | Notes                               |
|----------------------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------|
| Motor peak efficiency (SiC inverter)   | 95–98%         | At optimal operating point          |
| Motor continuous efficiency (WLTP avg) | 91–94%         | Weighted over drive cycle           |
| Inverter efficiency (SiC)              | 98–99%         | Peak; lower at partial load         |
| EDU total efficiency (WLTP)            | 91–94%         | Motor + inverter + gearbox combined |
| Motor peak power (typical BEV)         | 150–300 kW     | Programme-dependent                 |
| Motor continuous power                 | 50–60% of peak | Thermally limited                   |
| Peak torque duration                   | 10–30 seconds  | From cold; shorter from hot         |

## 15.2 Thermal Limits Quick Reference

| Component                | Continuous Limit | Peak Limit | Hard Absolute Limit |
|--------------------------|------------------|------------|---------------------|
| Stator winding (Class F) | 155°C            | 170°C      | 180°C               |
| Stator winding (Class H) | 180°C            | 200°C      | 220°C               |
| Rotor magnet (N45SH)     | 120°C            | 140°C      | 150°C               |
| Bearing (standard)       | 120°C            | 140°C      | 160°C               |
| Oil sump                 | 125°C            | 135°C      | 145°C               |
| IGBT junction (Si)       | 150°C            | 165°C      | 175°C               |
| SiC MOSFET junction      | 175°C            | 185°C      | 200°C               |

## 15.3 Flow Rate Reference

| Circuit / Condition            | Min Flow      | Nominal Flow | Max Flow    |
|--------------------------------|---------------|--------------|-------------|
| Oil — VSC minimum (standstill) | 0.5–1.5 L/min | —            | —           |
| Oil — continuous operation     | 2–3 L/min     | 4–6 L/min    | 8–10 L/min  |
| Oil — peak performance         | 6–8 L/min     | 8–10 L/min   | 10–12 L/min |
| Coolant — stator jacket        | 5–8 L/min     | 10–15 L/min  | 18–22 L/min |



| Circuit / Condition           | Min Flow    | Nominal Flow | Max Flow    |
|-------------------------------|-------------|--------------|-------------|
| Coolant — inverter cold plate | 5–8 L/min   | 8–12 L/min   | 15–18 L/min |
| Coolant — combined EDU        | 10–12 L/min | 15–20 L/min  | 22–28 L/min |

## 15.4 Key Material Properties

| Material                   | Density (kg/m³) | Cp (J/kg·K) | Thermal Cond. (W/m·K) |
|----------------------------|-----------------|-------------|-----------------------|
| Copper (winding)           | 8,900           | 385         | 400                   |
| Silicon steel (lamination) | 7,600           | 460         | 25–40                 |
| Aluminium (housing)        | 2,700           | 900         | 150–200               |
| NdFeB magnet               | 7,500           | 420         | 6–9                   |
| ATF/EV oil (100°C)         | ~830            | ~2100       | ~0.14                 |
| Water-glycol 50/50 (70°C)  | ~1040           | ~3700       | ~0.42                 |
| Slot liner (Nomex/Kapton)  | ~1,400          | ~1,100      | 0.15–0.25             |
| Epoxy impregnation         | ~1,200          | ~1,000      | 0.2–1.0               |

## 15.5 Copper Resistance Temperature Correction

| Winding Temperature | R/R_20 Factor | Copper Loss Multiplier vs Cold |
|---------------------|---------------|--------------------------------|
| 20°C                | 1.000         | 1.00× (reference)              |
| 60°C                | 1.157         | 1.16× — warm motor             |
| 100°C               | 1.314         | 1.31× — normal operating       |
| 130°C               | 1.431         | 1.43× — aggressive driving     |
| 160°C               | 1.549         | 1.55× — derate zone            |
| 180°C               | 1.627         | 1.63× — class limit            |

## 15.6 Magnet Property vs Temperature (NdFeB N45SH)

| Temperature | Br (T) | Hci (kA/m) | Relative Demag. Risk       |
|-------------|--------|------------|----------------------------|
| 20°C        | 1.35   | 1600       | Very Low — full properties |
| 60°C        | 1.31   | 1380       | Low                        |
| 80°C        | 1.28   | 1270       | Low-Moderate — normal warm |
| 100°C       | 1.26   | 1150       | Moderate — FW care needed  |
| 120°C       | 1.23   | 1020       | High — continuous limit    |

| Temperature | Br (T) | Hci (kA/m) | Relative Demag. Risk                  |
|-------------|--------|------------|---------------------------------------|
| 140°C       | 1.21   | 900        | Very High — peak limit                |
| 160°C       | 1.18   | 780        | CRITICAL — avoid under all conditions |

15.7 Insulation Class Summary

| Class     | Max Continuous Temp | Typical Material               | EV Application                        |
|-----------|---------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Class A   | 105°C               | Cotton, paper, natural resins  | Not used in EV motors                 |
| Class E   | 120°C               | Some synthetic resins          | Not used in EV motors                 |
| Class B   | 130°C               | Mica, glass fibre, asphalt     | Legacy industrial motors              |
| Class F   | 155°C               | Epoxy resins, glass fibre      | Early EV designs; budget applications |
| Class H   | 180°C               | Silicone elastomers, polyimide | Most current production EV motors     |
| Class C   | >180°C              | Polyimide, PTFE, ceramic       | High performance EVs; motorsport      |
| 200 / 220 | 200–220°C           | Advanced polyimide systems     | Next-gen high-performance EV motors   |

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## END OF DOCUMENT

EV Powertrain Cooling & Lubrication — Systems Engineering Reference

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